

## Healey says shelter checks were ordered but not done

Governor would consider limits to law guaranteeing families a place to stay

By Matt Stout and Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey said Friday the state will perform full criminal background checks on each of the thousands of people staying in Massachusetts’ emergency shelter system, saying she ordered such a step last spring but that the checks were not conducted.

Healey, who declined to share why those criminal checks she ordered did not happen, also said she is tapping former Boston police commissioner Edward Davis to lead a review of the security protocols for the emergency assistance program.

And, in a potentially dramatic shift, the governor signaled she is open to changing Massachusetts’ unique right-to-shelter law so that it would apply only to those who have lived here for a certain amount of time, arguing the original intent of the law was not to cover “waves and waves of people” coming from outside the state.

The announcements came as Healey faces mounting questions and criticism over public safety at the shelters after an undocumented immigrant was arrested this week on gun and drug charges at a Revere hotel being used as a shelter. Administration officials on Thursday acknowledged to the Globe the state had not been conducting full criminal background checks on those in emergency shelters, despite repeated assurances for months its vetting process was thorough.

## Property tax bills leave some reeling

First levies since Wu’s failed bid to block sharp increase

By Niki Griswold

GLOBE STAFF

Betty McGuire has lived in her Dorchester triple-decker for nearly 60 years. It’s where she and her husband raised their nine children and watched their family grow to include 19 grandchildren and seven great-grandchildren.

“I want to be able to leave it” to them, McGuire, 80, said. “We’ve been here all our life. The kids have all grown up here.”

But as Boston’s cost of living continues to climb, staying in her home feels increasingly challenging. When her latest property tax bill landed in her mailbox at the start of the month, her concern intensified. It was about \$260 higher than her previous quarter bill, a 44.5 percent increase from her last bill in October — far more than she expected.

“‘Lord, help me to make it,’ that’s all I was thinking about,” she said. “I can’t afford it, but I don’t know what to do.”

McGuire isn’t the only Boston resident feeling the pinch this month, as homeowners and other residential property owners across the city open their January property tax bills. These are the first bills issued since Mayor Michelle Wu failed to con-

PROPERTY TAXES, Page A6

## Sentenced but not punished



JABIN BOTSFORD/POOL/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

President-elect Donald Trump and his lawyer Todd Blanche appeared in the Manhattan courtroom via video conference.

### Lenient result demonstrates judicial dilemma when felon is president-elect

By Ben Protess,  
Jonah E. Bromwich,  
and Kate Christobek

NEW YORK TIMES

Arms crossed, scowl set, President-elect Donald Trump avoided jail, but became a felon.

Trump appeared virtually at his criminal sentencing on Friday from his Mar-a-Lago estate in Florida, more than 1,000 miles away from the chilly Manhattan courtroom where his case was called for a final time. Projected on a 60-inch screen, his image loomed over the gallery as a prosecutor recounted his crimes and a judge imposed his sentence.

Trump once faced up to four years in prison for falsifying business records to cover up a sex scandal, but on Friday, he received only a so-called unconditional discharge. The sentence, a rare and lenient alternative to jail or probation, reflected the practical and constitutional impossibil-



ADAM GRAY/GETTY IMAGES

Outside the court, supporters and critics of the president-elect made their feelings known on Friday morning.

ity of jailing a president-elect.

It nonetheless carried symbolic significance, capping a years-long ordeal that consumed Trump as a weary nation reckoned with the prospect of a crim-

inal president. Once the sentencing concluded, it cemented his status as the first felon to occupy the Oval Office.

“Never before has this court been presented with such a

unique and remarkable set of circumstances,” said the trial judge, Juan M. Merchan, who has felt the brunt of Trump’s rage over the case the past two years. “This has been a truly extraordinary case.”

It was also “a bit of a paradox,” he said, as the somber ritual of sentencing testified to both the supremacy and limits of presidential power.

The fact that the proceeding happened at all — despite Trump’s frenzied effort to shut it down — showed that the man preparing to reclaim the nation’s highest office was not entirely above the law. The machinery of New York’s justice system briefly brought him low, albeit in the comfort of his Florida mansion.

Yet nearly every detail of the highly scripted session demonstrated the singularity of the defendant: the months of delays,

TRUMP, Page A7

## Tatte workers forced to resign over paperwork issues

Move highlights fears that firings tied to immigration will rise in days ahead

By Diti Kohli  
and Katie Johnston

GLOBE STAFF

Around 60 employees at Boston-area Tattle locations were forced to resign in recent weeks after being flagged by the Internal Revenue Service over paperwork discrepancies that could be tied to their immigration status, the company confirmed Friday.

The move reflects fears from advocates and attorneys that immigration-related terminations will rise under the incoming Trump administration and hit the food industry and its many migrant workers especially hard. On the campaign trail, President-elect Donald Trump promised mass deportations and crackdowns on undocumented immigrants.

Helena DaSilva Hughes, president of the Immigrants’ Assistance Center in New Bedford, said that may push companies to take a closer look at the employees on payroll.

“They know that they’re being watched,” she said.

At Tattle, a spokesperson for the popular restaurant chain said the affected workers had been flagged by the Internal Revenue Service as many as three times over multiple years due to issues with their names and Social Security numbers in government records — a potential sign

of problems with their immigration status. At least some of the workers were undocumented, the Globe found in interviews with employees.

The company gave employees flagged by the IRS until this week to provide the necessary paperwork, according to a letter sent by Tattle to a worker and reviewed by the Globe. If employees did not do so, Tattle “will consider you to have voluntarily resigned from your position,” the letter continued.

TATTE, Page A10

### WHAT REMAINS



ARIANA DREHSLER/NEW YORK TIMES

A stairwell remained amid the burned ruins of a home destroyed by the Palisades fire along the water in Malibu, Calif. Firefighters made some small progress Friday in their fight to corral the deadly fires that have burned for days across the Los Angeles area. **A2.**

## Supreme Court signals support for TikTok ban

Justices focus on potential for harm to users

By Adam Liptak

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court seemed inclined on Friday to uphold a law that could effectively ban TikTok, the wildly popular app used by half of the country.

Even as several justices expressed concerns that the law was in tension with the First Amendment, a majority appeared satisfied that it was aimed not at TikTok’s speech rights but rather at its ownership, which the government

says is controlled by China. The law requires the app’s parent company, ByteDance, to sell TikTok by Jan. 19. If it does not, the law requires the app to be shut down.

The government offered two rationales for the law: combating covert disinformation from China and barring it from harvesting private information about Americans. The court was divided over the first justification. But several justices seemed troubled by the possibility that China could use data culled from the app for espionage or blackmail.

“Congress and the president were concerned,” Justice

TIKTOK, Page A6

A music teacher at Buckingham Browne & Nichols pleaded not guilty after being arrested on child pornography charges. **B1.**

The United States announced new sanctions targeting Russia’s energy sector and its “shadow fleet” of oil tankers. **A7.**

The economy added 256,000 jobs in December, seasonally adjusted, the Labor Department reported. **D1.**



### Just a dusting

**Saturday:** Colder, light snow. High: 29-34. Low: 22-28.

**Sunday:** Sunny, breezy. High: 34-39. Low: 25-30.

Sunrise: 7:12 Sunset: 4:32

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 307, NO. 11

\*

Suggested retail price  
\$4.00

